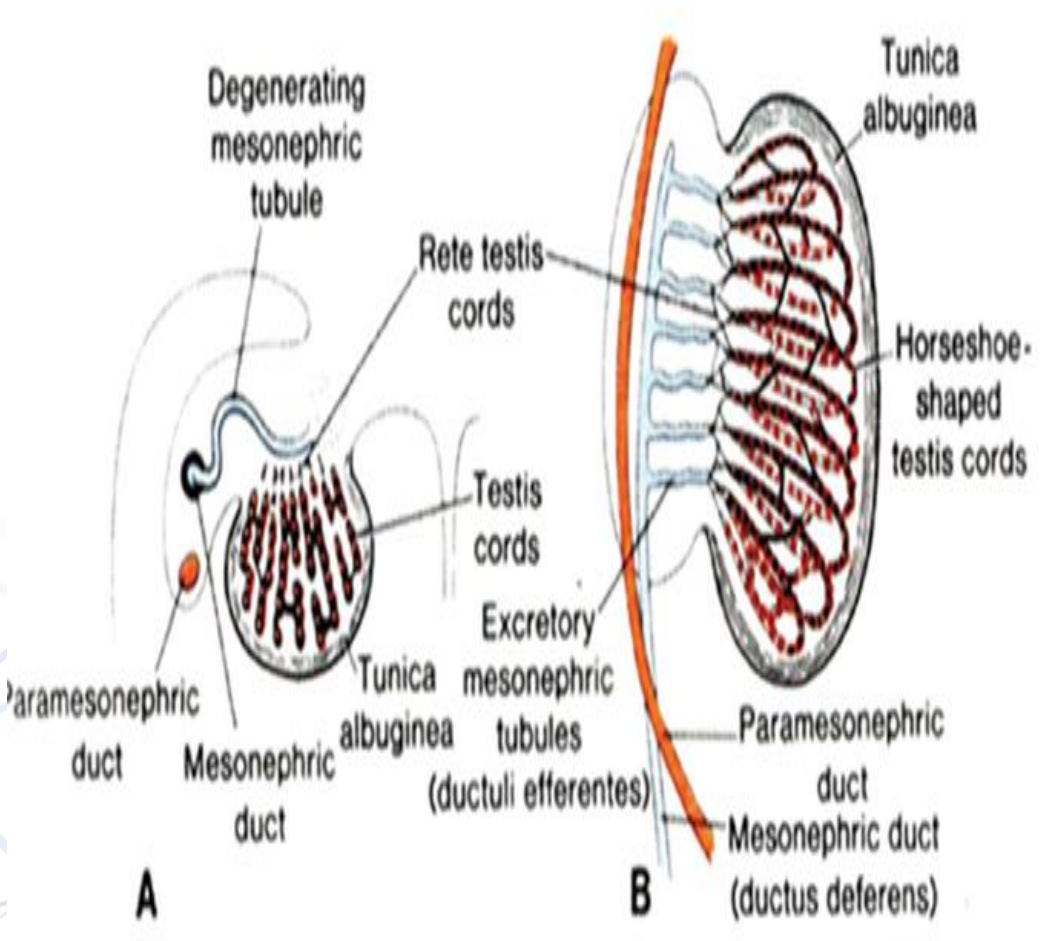
Development of the Testis

- Under the influence of SRY gene which encodes the testis determining factor, the primitive sex cords continue to proliferate forming the testis cords.
- Towards the hilum of the gland, the cords break up forming the rete testes.
- Testis cords then lose their connection with the surface epithelium and a dense fibrous connective tissue layer (tunica albuginea) separates the testis from the surface epithelium.

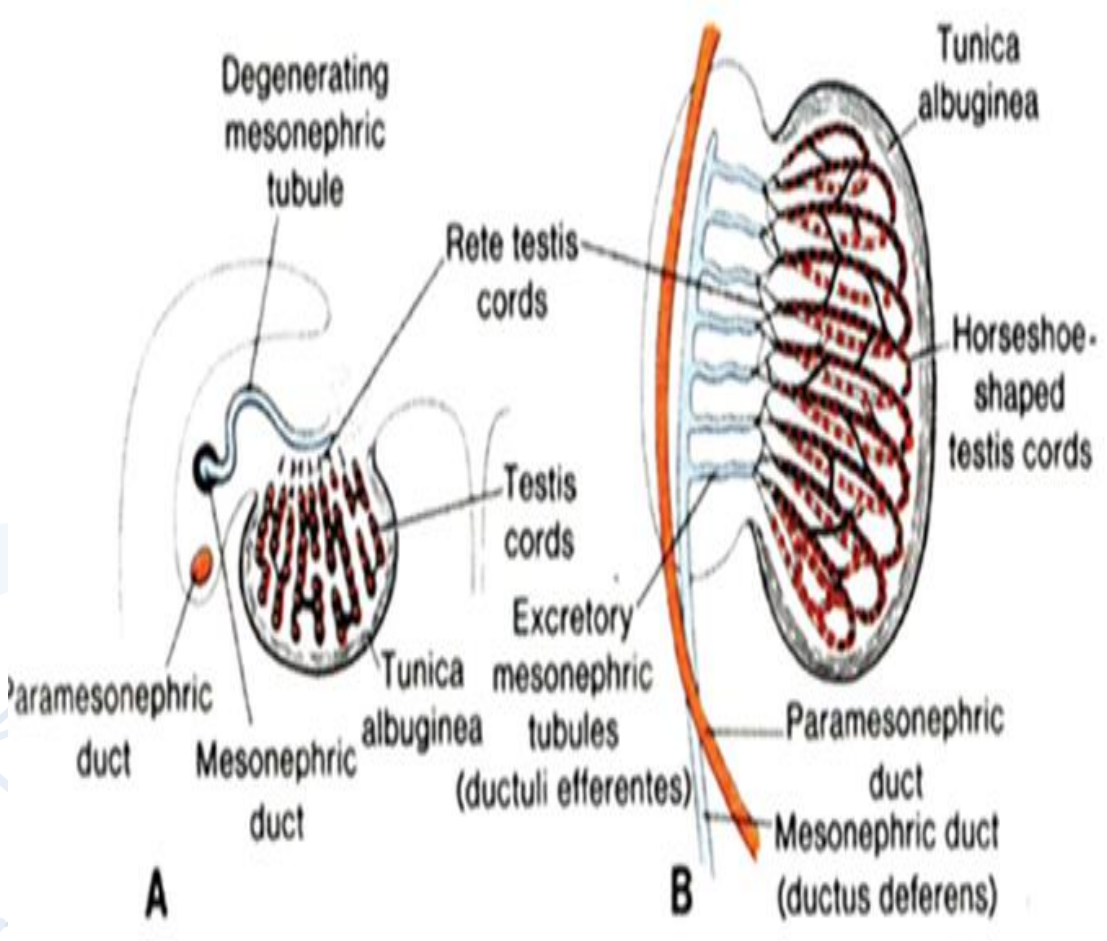


Development of the Testis

- In the **fourth month**, the testis cords become horse shoe shaped, and their extremities are continuous with those of the rete testis.

- **Testis cords** are composed of **primordial germ cells** and **sustentacular cells of Sertoli** (derived from the surface epithelium of the gland).

- The **testis cords** remain **solid** until **puberty** where they become **canalized** forming **seminiferous tubules**.



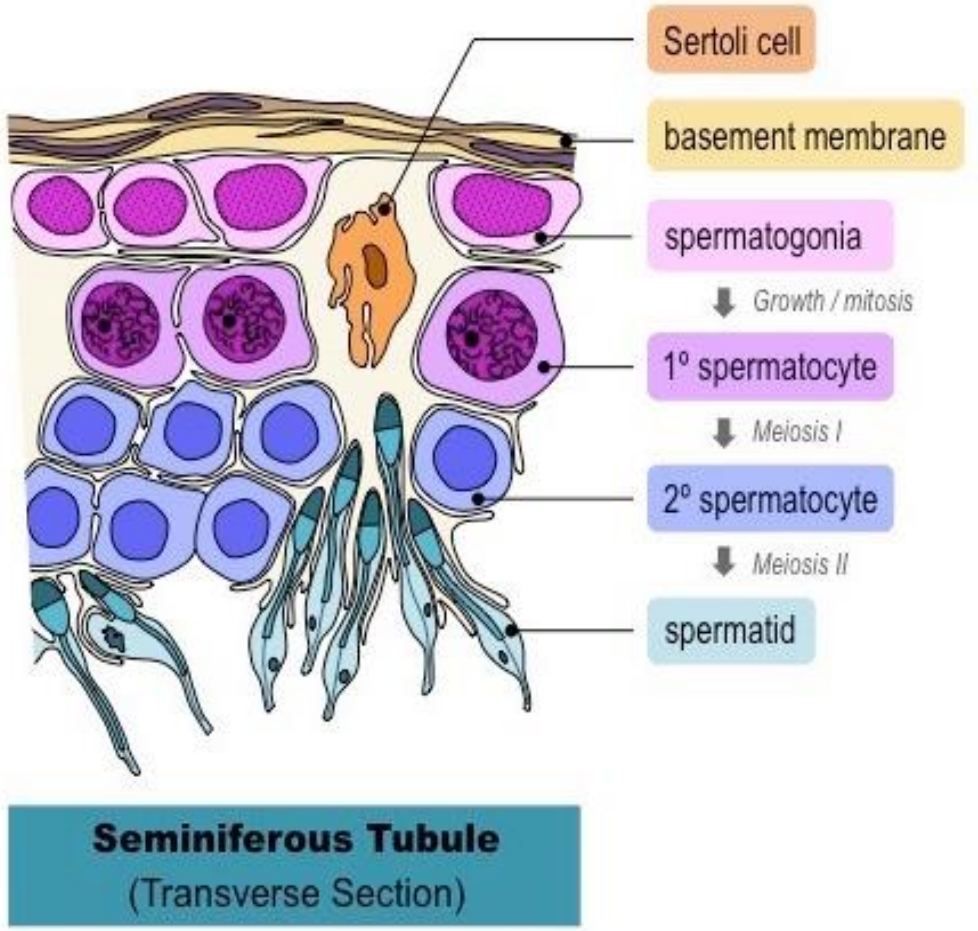
Development of the Testis

- The seminiferous tubules have 2 types of cells :

1- Sertoli cells (derived from the surface epithelium).

2- Spermatogonia (derived from the primordial germ cells).

- The rete testis becomes continuous with the mesonephric tubules which become the efferent ductules of the testis



Development of the Testis

- Interstitial cells of Leydig :

- They are derived from the **mesenchyme** of the gonadal ridge and lie between the testis cords.
- They begin the production of **testosterone**, and the testis becomes able to influence sexual differentiation of the genital ducts and external genitalia.

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Development of the Testis

